

NIKHILESH GAWHALE

Backend Engineer (AI) | Python, Claude-Accelerated Development & Production AI Features

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend engineer who ships production AI features end-to-end — using Claude and other AI tools as a daily co-pilot to accelerate development while owning the quality and review of every line that goes out. Strong Python with REST API design (FastAPI), PostgreSQL and ORM-based data modelling, containerised deployment (Docker, Kubernetes) and CI/CD. Demonstrated experience shipping real products powered by Anthropic Claude: a production agentic platform in investment-banking technology, with end-to-end ownership from architecture through deployment to monitoring. Excellent async communication and remote collaboration, and a track record of owning bugs and performance from design to production. MSc Artificial Intelligence (Distinction), Queen Mary University of London.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Backend & Python: Python (async/await, asyncio, Pydantic v2), FastAPI, Flask, REST APIs, microservices, software design patterns, clean code, testing (pytest); familiarity with Node.js

AI-Accelerated Development: Claude Code, Cursor, GitHub Copilot, prompt engineering, AI-assisted refactoring, responsible/critical review of AI-generated code, knowing when to use AI vs write manually

AI Products & LLM Systems: Anthropic Claude (production), OpenAI, Azure OpenAI, agentic workflows (LangGraph, CrewAI), RAG, LLM evaluation, structured outputs, function calling

Databases: PostgreSQL (queries, schema design, performance), SQLAlchemy ORM (Python equivalent of Sequelize/TypeORM), MongoDB, Redis, pgvector, SQL & NoSQL fundamentals

Cloud & DevOps: Docker, Docker Compose, Kubernetes, CI/CD (GitHub Actions, GitLab CI/CD), AWS (Bedrock, Lambda, S3), Azure (OpenAI, ML, AKS), Git, Agile

Engineering Practices: End-to-end feature ownership, code review, monitoring & incident response, secure coding, async remote collaboration, technical communication to non-technical stakeholders

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

AI / Backend Engineer, RP-Tech International Solutions (Investment Banking Technology), Remote | Jan 2025 – Apr 2026

- Shipped real AI products powered by Anthropic Claude into production — a contract-review platform with agentic workflows, document intelligence and human-in-the-loop oversight — owning features end-to-end from design through deployment, monitoring and iteration.
- Used AI coding tools (Claude Code, Cursor) as a daily co-pilot to accelerate development — generating boilerplate, scaffolding tests and refactoring — while critically reviewing every AI-generated change before shipping and maintaining strong engineering fundamentals (clean Python, pytest coverage, code review).
- Designed and integrated REST APIs (FastAPI), PostgreSQL schemas and Docker/Kubernetes deployments; instrumented production observability (p50/p95/p99 latency, throughput, cost, prompt-cache hit rate) and pytest regression checks in CI to debug production issues at speed without sacrificing quality.
- Collaborated remotely with Product, Engineering and stakeholders across time zones — explaining technical constraints clearly, translating ambiguous requirements into solutions, and proactively communicating status, blockers and decisions in async channels.

Generative AI / Backend Engineer, Midas Advisory, London, UK | Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

- Built Python/FastAPI backend services and REST APIs powering production LLM features — RAG pipelines, retrieval and grounded answering — with PostgreSQL data modelling, containerised deployment (Docker) and CI/CD (GitHub Actions).
- Owned features end-to-end and partnered with product, design and engineering to turn ambiguous requirements into shipped, measurable improvements; debugged production issues and iterated on latency and reliability.

Software Developer, Global Technologies, Pune, India | Aug 2022 – Sep 2023

- Wrote production-grade Python backend services and automation with REST API integrations, PostgreSQL data layer and disciplined Git version control, code review and automated testing across an Agile delivery team.
- Designed predictive monitoring and anomaly-detection pipelines (pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn), improving operational reliability by 45%; took technical solutions end-to-end from design to deployment to production support.

EDUCATION

MSc Artificial Intelligence — Distinction, Queen Mary University of London, UK | Sep 2023 – Sep 2024

Relevant modules: Deep Learning (90%), Machine Learning Algorithms (89%), Bayesian Neural Networks (88%), Natural Language Processing (85%)

BCA Bachelor of Computer Applications — GPA 7.8/10, Shivaji Science College, Amravati, India | Aug 2019 – Aug 2022